

TextEditor+

User Manual

Version 3.0.0

A lightweight code and text editor for macOS, Windows and Linux

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Contents

1 Introduction **3**
1.1 About this manual . . . 3

2 Installing TextEditor+ **4**
2.1 macOS . . . 4
2.2 Windows . . . 4
2.3 Linux . . . 4

3 A tour of the window **5**
3.1 The toolbar . . . 5
3.2 Tabs . . . 6
3.3 The editing area . . . 6
3.4 The status bar . . . 6
3.5 The title bar . . . 6

4 Opening files **7**
4.1 Ways to open a file . . . 7
4.2 Safeguards when opening . . . 7
4.3 Encodings . . . 8

5 Editing text **8**
5.1 The Edit menu . . . 8
5.2 Automatic indentation . . . 8
5.3 Go to Line . . . 8
5.4 Spelling . . . 8

6 Find and replace **9**
6.1 Finding text . . . 9
6.2 Search options . . . 9
6.3 Replacing text . . . 10
6.4 Regular expressions . . . 10

7 Syntax highlighting **10**

8 The live preview **11**
8.1 Markdown . . . 11
8.2 HTML . . . 11
8.3 LaTeX . . . 12
8.4 Closing the preview . . . 12

9 The grid view (CSV and TSV) **12**
9.1 Reading the file . . . 12
9.2 Sorting, filtering and searching . . . 13
9.3 Formulas . . . 13

10 Customising the view **13**
10.1 Themes . . . 13
10.2 Word wrap . . . 14
10.3 Font and text size . . . 14
10.4 Settings . . . 14

10.5 What TextEditor+ remembers . . . 15

11 Saving files **15**
11.1 Save and Save As . . . 15
11.2 How files are saved . . . 15
11.3 Unsaved changes . . . 16

12 Folders and the sidebar **16**
12.1 Opening a folder . . . 16
12.2 Using the sidebar . . . 16
12.3 File commands . . . 16

13 Files on a server (SFTP) **17**
13.1 Connecting . . . 17
13.2 Logging in . . . 17
13.3 The server's key . . . 17
13.4 Working with remote files . . . 18
13.5 On Windows . . . 18

14 Printing **18**

15 Closing and quitting **19**
15.1 Close Tab, Close Window and Quit . . . 19
15.2 On macOS . . . 19
15.3 On Windows and Linux . . . 19

16 Keyboard shortcut reference **20**

17 Troubleshooting **21**

18 About TextEditor+ **22**

1 Introduction

TextEditor+ is a fast, lightweight editor for code and plain text. It is the native desktop version of Web TextEditor, the browser-based editor on sjwrc.com, and keeps its look and features while adding your operating system's own file dialogs, printing, find and replace, and more.

TextEditor+ is built for quick edits: it opens instantly and stays out of your way. Its main features are:

- **Tabs and folders** (new in 2.0): open several files at once, each in its own tab, and browse a folder in the sidebar.
- **Files on servers** (new in 2.0): open, edit and save files and folders on any SFTP server, using your existing SSH keys.
- **Syntax highlighting** for HTML (including embedded `<script>` and `<style>` sections), CSS, JavaScript, C, C++, and (new in 2.5) Markdown, Python, Rust and LaTeX, chosen automatically from the file name.
- **Live preview** (new in 2.5): LaTeX, Markdown and HTML documents are shown formatted beside the text as you type (section 8).
- **Grid view for CSV and TSV** (new in 3.0): switch a comma- or tab-separated file to a spreadsheet-style grid with sorting, filtering, search and formulas — arithmetic, statistical, financial, logical and text functions (section 9).
- **Classic scroll bars** (new in 2.5): a glossy blue thumb, with both arrow buttons together at the end.
- **Two colour themes**: Dark and Light.
- **Colourful toolbar icons and Settings** (new in 2.5): choose how the toolbar looks and which buttons it shows, the theme, line numbers and spell checking (section 10.4).
- **Spell checking** (new in 2.5) with your system's dictionary, in text, comments and strings (section 5.4).
- **Comfortable editing**: line numbers, current-line highlight, automatic indentation, word wrap and Go to Line.
- **Find and replace** with case matching, whole-word search, regular expressions and back-references.
- **Faithful saving**: every file keeps its line endings and encoding, and saves are atomic, so a failed save never leaves a half-written file.
- **Printing** of a whole file or a selection, in colours suited to paper.
- **Safeguards** against opening devices, binary files and very large files by accident, and a warning before saving over changes someone else made.

1.1 About this manual

This manual covers TextEditor+ 3.0.0. Keyboard shortcuts are given for macOS first and for Windows and Linux second, for example `⌘S` / `Ctrl+S`. On a Mac, `⌘` is the Command key, `⌥` is Option, `⇧` is Shift and `⌃` is Control. Menu commands are written as **File > Save As…**.

2 Installing TextEditor+

2.1 macOS

TextEditor+ for macOS is distributed as a disk image, `TextEditor+-3.0.0.dmg`, for Apple Silicon (M-series) Macs.

1. Double-click `TextEditor+-3.0.0.dmg` to open it.
2. Drag **TextEditor+** onto the **Applications** folder shown in the same window.
3. Eject the disk image.

The current build is not notarised by Apple, so macOS blocks the first launch with a message that it cannot verify the app. To open it the first time, either:

- **Control-click** (or right-click) TextEditor+ in the Applications folder, choose **Open**, and confirm with Open; or
- try to open it normally, then go to **System Settings > Privacy & Security** and click Open Anyway.

You only need to do this once. After that, TextEditor+ opens like any other app.

2.2 Windows

TextEditor+ for Windows is a portable app for 64-bit Windows 10 and 11, distributed as a zip file, `TextEditor+-3.0.0-windows-x64.zip`. It needs no installation.

1. Extract the whole folder from the zip file to wherever you like: your Documents folder, the desktop or a USB stick. Don't run TextEditor+ from inside the zip file.
2. Double-click `TextEditor+.exe` in the extracted folder.

The program isn't signed, so the first time you run it Windows SmartScreen may say "Windows protected your PC". Click More info, then Run anyway.

The portable version keeps its settings in the `settings` folder next to `TextEditor+.exe` rather than in the Windows registry, so they travel with the folder. Besides the window and editor settings, this includes your open tabs and sidebar folder, the Open Recent list and your saved servers, but never a password. That folder must be writable for settings to be saved. If you delete the `settings` folder, TextEditor+ stores its settings in the registry like an installed program.

To remove TextEditor+, delete its folder. Nothing else was installed; a server key you chose to trust stays in your `.ssh\known_hosts` file, as it would for the `ssh` command.

The folder also contains `README.txt`, this manual, and a `licenses` folder with the licences of TextEditor+ and the libraries it includes (Qt, libssh, OpenSSL and the LLVM and MinGW runtime libraries).

2.3 Linux

There are no prebuilt packages for Linux yet. TextEditor+ can be built from source with Qt 6.4 or later, CMake 3.21 or later, a C++17 compiler and, for SFTP, libssh 0.11.5 or later; the `README.md` file in the source code has step-by-step instructions.

> **Note** Everything in this manual applies to all three platforms unless a section says otherwise. A few behaviours, such as dropping files on the Dock icon, exist only on macOS.

3 A tour of the window

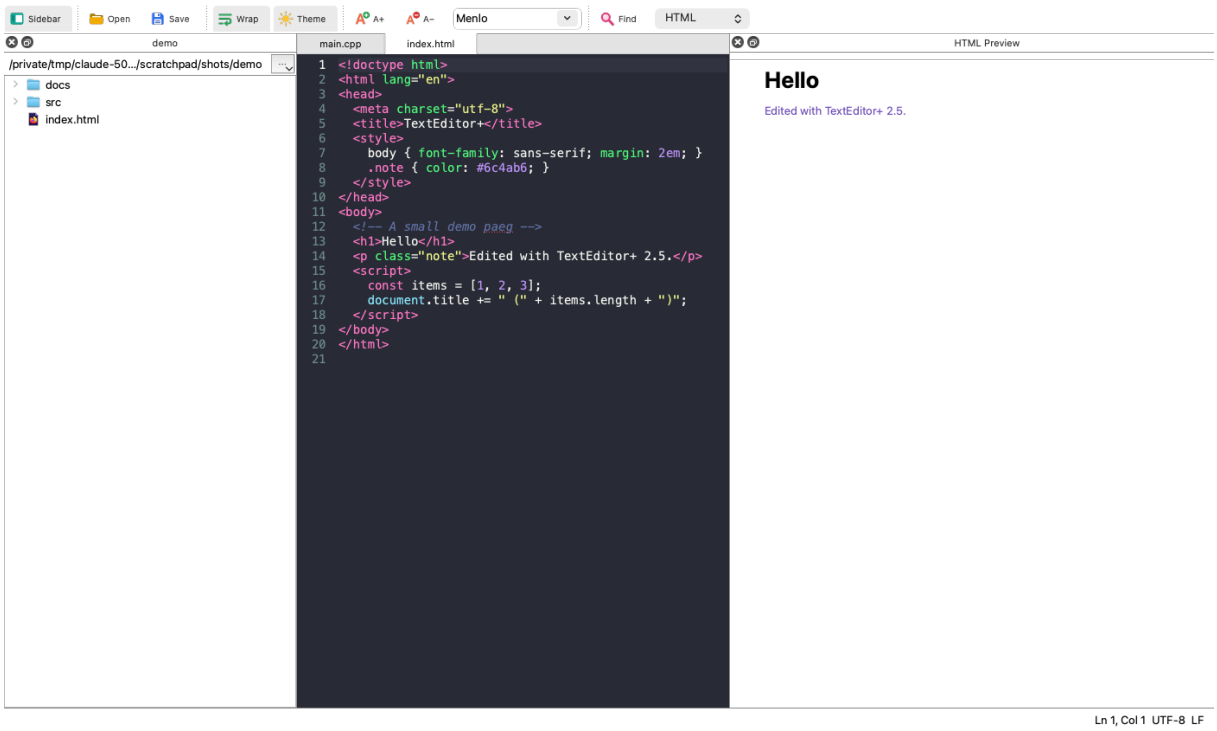


Figure 1: TextEditor+ with a folder open in the sidebar and two files in tabs.

The TextEditor+ window (Figure 1) has a toolbar, a row of tabs, one for each open file, the editing area, a status bar and, when you open a folder, a sidebar listing its files (section 12).

3.1 The toolbar

Each toolbar button has a coloured icon with its name beside it. From left to right, the toolbar holds:

Control	What it does
Sidebar	Shows or hides the folder sidebar (section 12).
Open	Opens a file (section 4).
Save	Saves the current file (section 11).
Wrap	Turns word wrap on or off. Highlighted when on.
Theme	Switches between the dark and light themes. Highlighted when the dark theme is on.
A+ A−	Makes the text larger or smaller.
Font box	Chooses the editor font. Only monospaced (fixed-width) fonts are listed.
Find	Opens the find bar (section 6).
Language box	Chooses the syntax highlighting (section 7).

The Theme button shows a sun in the dark theme and a moon in the light one: the theme it switches to. In Settings (section 10.4) you can put the names under the icons or show the icons alone, and hide buttons you don't use. Point at a button to see its name and keyboard shortcut. Hidden buttons' commands stay in the menus.

3.2 Tabs

Each open file has its own tab above the editing area, showing the file's name. A dot (•) after the name means the file has unsaved changes. Point at a tab to see the file's full path, or its `sftp://` address for a file on a server.

- Click a tab to switch to it, or press `⌃Tab` / `Ctrl+Tab` for the next tab and `⌃⇧Tab` / `Ctrl+⇧Tab` for the previous one.
- Drag a tab to move it.
- Close a tab with its close button, **File > Close Tab** or `⌘W` / `Ctrl+W`. Closing the last tab leaves an empty, untitled one.
- **File > New Tab** (`⌘N` / `Ctrl+N`, or `⌘T` / `Ctrl+T`) opens a tab for a new file.

Menu commands, the find bar, the status bar and the language box always apply to the tab you are looking at. The theme, font, text size and word wrap apply to all tabs.

3.3 The editing area

The editing area shows your text with line numbers on the left (you can turn them off in Settings). The line containing the cursor is highlighted, and its line number is drawn in a brighter colour. Misspelled words are underlined with a red dotted line (section 5.4).

The scroll bars are drawn in the TextEditor+ "Classic" style, on every platform: a glossy blue thumb that turns grey while the window is in the background, and both arrow buttons together at the bottom (or right-hand) end. Click an arrow to scroll a line, click the track to scroll a page, or drag the thumb. In the dark theme the track and buttons are dark too.

3.4 The status bar

The status bar along the bottom shows, from left to right:

- the cursor position, as Ln (line) and Col (column);
- the file's text encoding, UTF-8 or Latin-1;
- the file's line endings, LF (macOS and Linux style) or CRLF (Windows style).

Short messages, such as "Saved notes.txt", also appear briefly on the left of the status bar.

3.5 The title bar

The title bar shows the name of the current tab's file, or Untitled for a new one. For a file on a server, it also shows the server's name. When the file has unsaved changes, macOS shows a dot in the window's close button, and Windows and Linux add an asterisk (*) after the name.

4 Opening files

Each file you open gets its own tab (section 3.2). If the file is already open, TextEditor+ switches to its tab instead of opening it twice. If the current tab is an empty, untitled one, the file opens in it.

4.1 Ways to open a file

Open dialog
Choose **File > Open…**, press ⌘O / Ctrl+O, or click Open in the toolbar. The dialog starts in the folder of the file you have open. You can choose several files at once; each opens in its own tab. Use the file-type menu in the dialog to show only text, web or C/C++ files.

The sidebar
Click a file in the folder sidebar (section 12).

Open Recent
File > Open Recent lists the files and folders you opened lately, on this computer and on servers. **Clear Menu** empties the list.

Drag onto the window
Drag a file from Finder, File Explorer or your file manager and drop it anywhere on the editing area. Dropping a folder opens it in the sidebar.

Drag onto the Dock icon (macOS)
Drop a file on the TextEditor+ icon in the Dock. This works whether or not TextEditor+ is already running. Dropping a folder opens it in the sidebar.

Open With (macOS)
In Finder, Control-click a file and choose **Open With > TextEditor+**. TextEditor+ is listed for every file but never makes itself the default app for any file type, so double-clicking files keeps opening them in your usual apps.

Command line
Pass file or folder names when starting the program, for example `TextEditor+ notes.txt todo.md`, or `sftp://` addresses such as `TextEditor+sftp://alice@example.com/var/www/index.html`. Run `TextEditor+ --help` for the options, or `--version` to print the version.

When you open a file, TextEditor+ picks the syntax highlighting from its file extension (section 7).

4.2 Safeguards when opening

To protect you from mistakes, TextEditor+ checks each file before opening it:

- **Only regular files are opened.** Folders, devices and pipes are refused with a message, because reading them could never finish.
- **Binary files need confirmation.** If a file contains NUL bytes, which text files do not, TextEditor+ warns that it appears to be binary and asks whether to open it anyway.
- **Large files need confirmation.** Files over 50 MB can make the editor slow, so you are asked before they open.
- **Very large files are refused.** Files over 512 MB are not opened at all, because the whole file is held in memory.

- **Symbolic links are reported.** If the file is a symbolic link (alias), a message in the status bar names the file it points to; saving writes to that file and leaves the link in place.

The same checks apply to files on a server.

> **Caution** Saving a binary file from a text editor usually damages it. Open binary files only to look at them, and close them without saving.

4.3 Encodings

TextEditor+ reads files as UTF-8, the standard encoding for modern text. If a file is not valid UTF-8, it is opened as Latin-1 (ISO 8859-1) instead, the status bar shows Latin-1, and a message "Not valid UTF-8: opened as Latin-1" appears for a few seconds. Section 11 explains how the encoding is kept when you save.

5 Editing text

TextEditor+ supports the standard editing commands of your platform: typing, selecting with the mouse or with ⇧ and the arrow keys, and the usual clipboard commands.

5.1 The Edit menu

Command	macOS	Windows / Linux	Notes
Undo	⌘Z	Ctrl+Z	Unavailable when there is nothing to undo.
Redo	⇧⌘Z	Ctrl+Y or Ctrl+⇧Z	
Cut	⌘X	Ctrl+X	
Copy	⌘C	Ctrl+C	
Paste	⌘V	Ctrl+V	Always pastes plain text.
Select All	⌘A	Ctrl+A	

5.2 Automatic indentation

When you press Return / Enter, the new line starts with the same indentation (spaces and tabs) as the line above, so code stays lined up. Tab stops are four characters wide.

5.3 Go to Line

Choose **Edit > Go to Line…** or press ⌘L / Ctrl+L, type a line number, and press Return. The dialog shows the range of valid line numbers, and the line you choose is scrolled to the middle of the window.

5.4 Spelling

TextEditor+ underlines misspelled words with a red dotted line as you type. It checks the words people read, not code:

- all of a plain-text file;
- the text of Markdown, HTML and LaTeX files (not code spans, tags, commands or maths);
- comments and strings in program code.

Words that look like code are skipped: `camelCase` and `snake_case` names, words joined to digits, words in capitals such as `HTML`, single letters, and anything in a web address, e-mail address or file path.

Right-click an underlined word for suggestions; choose one to replace the word. Ignore Spelling accepts the word until you quit TextEditor+. Add to Dictionary adds it to your own dictionary for good.

The dictionary is your system's own, so it follows your language settings, and words you add are shared with other apps:

- **macOS**: the languages in **System Settings > Keyboard > Text Input > Edit > Spelling** (Automatic by Language by default).
- **Windows**: your Windows display language, or US English if Windows has no dictionary for it. Add a language's spelling under **Settings > Time & language > Language & region**.
- **Linux**: spell checking isn't available yet.

Turn spell checking off in Settings (section 10.4).

6 Find and replace

6.1 Finding text

Choose **Edit > Find…**, press `⌘F` / `Ctrl+F`, or click Find in the toolbar. The find bar opens above the text. If you had selected some text on a single line, it is filled in for you.

As you type, TextEditor+ jumps to the first match from the cursor. Then:

- press `Return` or click Next to go to the next match;
- press `⇧Return` or click Previous to go to the previous match;
- press `Esc` or click × to close the find bar.

You can also use **Edit > Find Next** (`⌘G` / `F3`) and **Edit > Find Previous** (`⇧⌘G` / `⇧F3`) with the find bar closed. Searching wraps around: after the last match it continues from the top of the file. If nothing matches, the find bar shows No matches in red.

6.2 Search options

Match case Only finds text with the same capitalisation; "Hello" no longer matches "hello".

Whole word Only finds complete words; "cat" no longer matches inside "concatenate".

Regex Treats the search text as a regular expression (section 6.4).

6.3 Replacing text

Choose **Edit** > **Replace…** or press `⌥⌘F` on macOS, `Ctrl+H` on Windows and most Linux desktops, or `Ctrl+R` on KDE. The find bar opens with the cursor in the Replace with box. Then:

- Replace (or `Return` in the Replace with box) replaces the selected match and moves on to the next one;
- Replace All replaces every match in the file and reports how many it replaced.

A Replace All can be undone in one step with **Edit** > **Undo**.

6.4 Regular expressions

With Regex ticked, the search text is a Perl-compatible regular expression. For example:

Pattern	Finds
`\d+`	one or more digits, such as 42
`colou?r`	“color” or “colour”
`^\s+$`	lines that contain only spaces or tabs
`(\w+)@(\w+)`	a word, an @ sign and another word

In the Replace with box, `\1`, `\2` and so on insert the text matched by the first, second, … group in parentheses. For example, searching for `(\w+)@(\w+)` and replacing with `\2 at \1` turns `alice@example` into `example at alice`.

If the pattern is not a valid regular expression, the find bar shows Invalid pattern and nothing is searched or replaced.

> **Note** Matches cannot span more than one line.

7 Syntax highlighting

TextEditor+ colours keywords, strings, numbers, comments and other parts of the text to make code easier to read. The highlighting language is chosen from the file extension when you open or save a file:

Language	File extensions
HTML	`.html .htm .xhtml .xml .svg .vue`
CSS	`.css .scss .less`
JavaScript	`.js .mjs .cjs .jsx .ts .tsx .json`
C	`.c .h`
C++	`.cpp .cc .cxx .hpp .hh .hxx .ino`
Markdown	`.md .markdown .mdown .mkd .mdx`
Python	`.py .pyw .pyi`
Rust	`.rs`
LaTeX	`.tex .latex .ltx .sty .cls`
Plain Text	anything else

In HTML files, the contents of `<script>` and `<style>` sections are highlighted as JavaScript and CSS.

To choose a language yourself, use the **Language** menu or the language box in the toolbar. Your choice applies until you open another file. Saving under a new name with a recognised extension switches to that extension's language; saving under a name the table doesn't list, such as `notes.txt`, keeps your choice.

8 The live preview

When the current tab holds a LaTeX, Markdown or HTML document, a preview appears in a sidebar on the right. It follows your typing, including changes you haven't saved, and hides again when you switch to a file it can't show. Drag its edge to make it wider or narrower. The preview's title says what it is showing: TeX Preview, Markdown Preview or HTML Preview.

8.1 Markdown

Markdown files (`.md`, `.markdown` and similar, or any tab whose language you set to Markdown) are shown formatted, in the colours of the current theme: headings, emphasis, lists and task lists, quotes, code (shaded), tables, links and images. GitHub-flavoured Markdown is understood.

8.2 HTML

HTML files (`.html`, `.htm` and `.xhtml`, or any tab whose language you set to HTML) are shown as a web page, black on white as a browser shows it unless the page sets its own colours. Style sheets in `<style>` sections, `style` attributes and `.css` files linked from the file's folder are applied, and images in the file's folder (or embedded as `data:` addresses) are shown. XML, SVG and Vue files, which are highlighted as HTML, have no preview.

The page is drawn by TextEditor+ itself rather than a web browser, so it is a preview of the page's content and styling, not an exact rendering: scripts don't run, CSS layout (such as flexbox, grid and positioning) is simplified, and nothing is ever fetched from the internet, so web fonts, remote images and remote style sheets are left out. Clicking a web link opens it in your browser.

8.3 LaTeX

When the current tab holds a LaTeX document (a `.tex`, `.latex` or `.ltx` file, or any tab whose language you set to LaTeX), the menu at the top of the preview chooses how it is made:

Quick Preview needs nothing else installed and updates as you type. It shows the title, sections and table of contents, lists, tables, figures and images, footnotes, cross-references and citations, theorems and proofs, verbatim text and your own `\newcommand` macros. Maths is drawn with proper symbols, superscripts and subscripts, and equations are numbered. It is an approximation: complicated maths, page layout and pictures drawn with TikZ appear only when typeset.

Typeset with ... appears for each TeX engine found on your computer: pdfLaTeX, XeLaTeX, LuaLaTeX (from MacTeX, TeX Live or MiKTeX) or Tectonic. A moment after you stop typing, the document is typeset and its pages are shown exactly as they will print (the first 40 pages). If the document has an error, the first one is shown above the pages, with its line number. Open PDF opens the typeset PDF in your PDF viewer. The pages are drawn with Poppler's `pdftoppm` or MuPDF's `mutool`; without either, use Open PDF.

When both a TeX engine and a PDF renderer are installed, the preview starts in Typeset mode; otherwise it starts in Quick Preview. Your choice is remembered.

> **Note** Typesetting starts as soon as you open a file, so it is kept safe even for documents you didn't write. It uses a private temporary folder, so nothing is written next to your file, and TeX's shell escape is always off. On macOS and Linux, TeX also runs in a sandbox that stops it writing anywhere else or using the network (Tectonic may still download packages). Tectonic and LuaLaTeX are offered only where there is such a sandbox. Files that the document loads from its own folder, such as images and `\input` files, are still found. Tectonic downloads the packages a document needs the first time it uses them, so the first preview can take a little while.

8.4 Closing the preview

To close the preview, click its close button; it then stays closed for all files until you choose **View > Show Preview** (⇧⌘P / Ctrl+⇧P).

9 The grid view (CSV and TSV)

When you open a comma- or tab-separated file (`.csv`, `.tsv` or `.tab`), the **Grid** button in the toolbar becomes available. Click it — or choose **View > Show as Grid** (⇧⌘G / Ctrl+⇧G) — to replace the text area with a spreadsheet-style grid. Click it again to return to the text.

The grid is an *analysis layer*. You can edit cells and write formulas in it, but nothing you do is written back to the file: the text on disk is left exactly as it was. Your work in the grid lasts for as long as the tab is open.

9.1 Reading the file

The field separator (comma, tab or semicolon) is detected from the file; if it is wrong, pick the right one from the **Separator** box. Quoted fields, commas inside quotes and line breaks inside quotes are all handled. Tick **First row is header** to use the first row as the column titles rather than as data.

9.2 Sorting, filtering and searching

- **Sort** by clicking a column header. Columns of numbers sort by value, not as text.
- **Filter** with the **Filter** button, which opens a bar where you choose a column, a condition (*contains*, *starts with*, =, ≠, >, ≥, <, ≤) and a value. Filters on different columns combine, so only rows that match all of them are shown. **Clear all** removes them.
- **Search** by typing in the **Search** box and stepping through the matches with the ‹ and › buttons (or Enter). ⌘F / Ctrl+F jumps to the box. Search only looks at the rows left by the filters.

9.3 Formulas

Select a cell and type a value, or a formula beginning with =, either straight into the cell or into the formula bar above the grid. The selected cell's address (such as B3) is shown on the left, and the status bar shows a formula's result.

Formulas use the usual spreadsheet references: a single cell A1, a range A1:B10, a whole column A:A or a whole row 2:5. They update as soon as the cells they depend on change, and one formula may build on another. The grid keeps a couple of spare rows and columns at the edges for scratch calculations, and adds more as you use them.

The following functions are available:

- **Maths:** ABS, SIGN, SQRT, EXP, LN, LOG, LOG10, INT, TRUNC, ROUND, ROUNDUP, ROUNDDOWN, CEILING, FLOOR, MOD, POWER, PI, SIN, COS, TAN, SUMPRODUCT, SUMSQ.
- **Statistical:** SUM, AVERAGE, MIN, MAX, MEDIAN, MODE, COUNT, COUNTA, PRODUCT, STDEV, STDEVP, VAR, VARP, PERCENTILE, QUARTILE, LARGE, SMALL, RANK, CORREL, COVAR, SLOPE, INTERCEPT, RSQ, GEOMEAN, HARMEAN, AVEDEV, DEVSQ.
- **Financial:** PMT, FV, PV, NPER, RATE, NPV, IRR, IPMT, PPMT, SLN, DDB.
- **Logical:** IF, IFERROR, AND, OR, NOT, TRUE, FALSE.
- **Text:** CONCAT, CONCATENATE, LEN, LEFT, RIGHT, MID, UPPER, LOWER, TRIM, SUBSTITUTE.

You can also use the operators +, -, *, /, ^ (power), % (percent) and & (join text), and the comparisons =, <>, <, >, <= and >=. A formula that cannot be worked out shows an error such as #DIV/0!, #VALUE!, #NAME?, #NUM! or #CIRC! (a formula that refers back to itself).

> **Examples** `=SUM(B2:B20)` `=AVERAGE(C:C)` `=PMT(0.05/12, 60, 20000)`
> `=IF(D2>100, "high", "low")` `=CORREL(A2:A50, B2:B50)`

10 Customising the view

10.1 Themes

TextEditor+ has a Dark theme and a Light theme. Switch between them with **View › Dark Theme**, Theme in the toolbar, or Theme in Settings. The Dark theme is used the first time you start TextEditor+. The Dark theme's colours come from the Dracula theme (https://draculatheme.com, MIT licence). The Light theme's colours are based on the "eclipse" theme for CodeMirror (MIT licence).

10.2 Word wrap

With word wrap on, long lines are wrapped to fit the window. With it off, they run off to the right and you scroll sideways to see them. Toggle it with **View > Word Wrap**, ⌥Z / Alt+Z, or Wrap in the toolbar. Word wrap only changes how lines are displayed, never the file itself.

10.3 Font and text size

Choose a font from the font box in the toolbar; only monospaced fonts are listed, so columns of code stay aligned. To change the text size:

Action	macOS	Windows / Linux
Zoom In	⌘= or ⌘+, or A+	Ctrl+= or Ctrl++, or A+
Zoom Out	⌘−, or A−	Ctrl+−, or A−
Actual Size	⌘0	Ctrl+0

You can also hold ⌘ / Ctrl and turn the mouse wheel, or scroll on a trackpad. Text sizes range from 6 to 72 points.

10.4 Settings

Choose **TextEditor+ > Settings…** on macOS (⌘,), or **Edit > Settings…** on Windows and Linux (Ctrl+,). Changes take effect straight away; click Close when you're done, or Restore Defaults to go back to how TextEditor+ started.

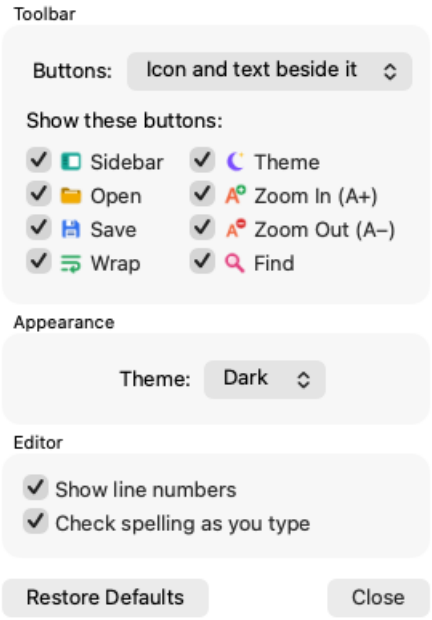


Figure 2: The Settings window, with everything as it starts.

Setting	What it does	At first
Buttons	How toolbar buttons look: Icon and text beside it, Text under icon or Icon only.	Icon and text
Show these buttons	Which buttons are on the toolbar. The font and language boxes are always shown.	All
Theme	Dark or Light.	Dark
Show line numbers	The line numbers beside the text.	On
Check spelling as you type	Underlines misspelled words (section 5.4). Greyed out where it isn't available.	On

10.5 What TextEditor+ remembers

When you close the window, TextEditor+ remembers its size and position, the font and text size, the theme, the word-wrap setting, whether the sidebar is shown and everything in Settings, and restores them the next time it starts.

It doesn't reopen your files: each time TextEditor+ starts, it opens a blank document. If you close the window with unsaved changes, it asks whether to save them first. Use **File > Open Recent** to get back to recent files and folders. Passwords are never remembered. Section 17 explains how to reset them.

11 Saving files

11.1 Save and Save As

- **File > Save** (`⌘S` / `Ctrl+S` , or Save in the toolbar) saves the file under its current name. A new, untitled file asks for a name first.
- **File > Save As…** (`⇧⌘S` / `Ctrl+⇧S`) saves under a new name. For a new file, the dialog suggests `untitled.txt` in your Documents folder.

11.2 How files are saved

TextEditor+ is careful to change only what you edited:

- **Line endings are kept.** A file with Windows-style (CRLF) line endings is saved with CRLF; anything else with LF. New files use LF.
- **The encoding is kept.** UTF-8 files are saved as UTF-8 and Latin-1 files as Latin-1. Latin-1 can only store 256 different characters, so if you have added a character it can't hold, such as "€" or an emoji, TextEditor+ asks whether to save the file as UTF-8 instead. Choose Cancel to go back and edit the text.
- **Saves are atomic.** The new text is written to a temporary file first and then swapped in. If a save fails, for example because the disk is full, the original file is left untouched and a message explains what went wrong.
- **Other people's changes are noticed.** If the file was changed by another program (or another person, on a server) since you opened it, TextEditor+ says so before saving. Choose Replace to save your version over theirs, Reload to throw away your changes and load theirs, or Cancel.

11.3 Unsaved changes

If a file has unsaved changes when you close its tab, close the window or quit, TextEditor+ asks whether to save them, one tab at a time:

Save saves the file, then carries on.

Don't Save / **Discard** throws the changes away, then carries on.

Cancel does nothing, so you can keep editing.

TextEditor+ does not save automatically, so remember to save your work.

12 Folders and the sidebar

Open a whole folder to see its files in the sidebar on the left of the window.

12.1 Opening a folder

Choose **File > Open Folder…** (⇧⌘O / Ctrl+⇧O), drop a folder on the window or on the Dock icon, pass a folder name on the command line, or pick one from **File > Open Recent**. The sidebar shows one folder at a time; opening another replaces it. **File > Close Folder** closes it.

Show or hide the sidebar with **View > Show Sidebar** (⌘\ / Ctrl+\ ) or Sidebar in the toolbar. Drag its title to move it to the other side of the window, or out into a separate panel.

12.2 Using the sidebar

- The folder's full path, or `sftp://` address, is shown at the top.
- Click a file to open it in a tab. Click a folder to open or close it.
- Folders are listed before files. Hidden files (names starting with a dot) are hidden; to show them, click at the top of the sidebar and choose Show Hidden Files.
- A local folder updates by itself when files change. A folder on a server doesn't, so use Refresh (in the menu or the right-click menu) to see changes made by others.

12.3 File commands

Right-click in the sidebar for these commands:

New File…, New Folder… Create an empty file or folder in the folder you clicked (or next to the file you clicked). A new file opens in a tab.

Rename… Renames a file or folder. Open tabs follow the file.

Move to Trash… / Delete… On this computer, the item moves to the Trash (Recycle Bin), so you can get it back. On a server, it is deleted for good, after you confirm; only empty folders can be deleted there.

Copy Path Copies the item's path or `sftp://` address.

Refresh Lists the folder again.

13 Files on a server (SFTP)

TextEditor+ can open and save files on any server you can reach with SFTP, the file-transfer part of SSH, which nearly every Linux, macOS and Unix server offers. It uses your existing SSH setup: the keys in your `.ssh` folder, `ssh-agent` (on macOS and Linux), and the settings in `~/.ssh/config`. Section 13.5 explains the differences on Windows.

13.1 Connecting

File > Connect to Server… (⌘K / Ctrl+K)
Asks for the server, then opens your starting folder there in the sidebar.

File > Open Remote File…
Asks for the server, then lets you pick a file to open.

File > Open Remote Folder…
Asks for the server, then lets you pick a folder for the sidebar.

In the Connect to Server window, fill in the server's name, the port (usually 22), your user name on the server and, if you like, a starting folder (your home folder if left empty). Or paste an address such as `sftp://alice@example.com:2222/var/www` into Address. Tick Remember this server to add it to the Saved servers list; only the address and folder are saved, never a password.

13.2 Logging in

TextEditor+ tries these ways to log in, in order:

1. `ssh-agent`, if it is running and holds a key (macOS and Linux);
2. your key files: the ones named in `~/.ssh/config`, then `id_ed25519`, `id_ecdsa` and `id_rsa`. If a key has a passphrase, you are asked for it;
3. the server's own questions (such as a password and a one-time code), or a password.

Passwords and passphrases are used once and forgotten: they are never saved, and you are asked again if TextEditor+ has to reconnect.

13.3 The server's key

The first time you connect to a server, TextEditor+ shows the server's key *fingerprint* and asks whether to trust it. Compare it with the fingerprint your server's administrator gives you. If you choose Trust and Connect, the key is added to `~/.ssh/known_hosts`, the same file the `ssh` command uses, and you aren't asked again.

> **If a server's key has changed** If a server presents a different key from the one recorded, TextEditor+ refuses to connect and explains why. This can mean that someone is intercepting the connection. If you know the key changed for a good reason (for example, the server was reinstalled), remove the old key, for example with `ssh-keygen -R example.com`, and connect again. There is deliberately no way to connect anyway.

13.4 Working with remote files

Files on a server open in tabs like any other, with the same safeguards (section 4). Their tabs show the `sftp://` address when you point at them.

- **Saving** replaces the file in one step, keeping its permissions, so a dropped connection never leaves a half-written file. If someone changed the file on the server since you opened it, you are asked first (section 11).
- **Save As** for a remote file picks a new name on the same server. **File > Save to Server…** saves any file to a server; its This Computer… button saves locally instead.
- **Slow connections:** if an operation takes more than a moment, a progress window appears; Cancel stops it.
- **Dropped connections:** your text stays in its tab. When you save, TextEditor+ reconnects (asking for a password if needed) and tries again.

> **Note** A save writes a temporary file named `.name.tetmp-…` next to the file and then swaps it in, so you need permission to create files in the file's folder. If the connection drops in the middle of a save, that hidden temporary file may be left behind; it is safe to delete.

13.5 On Windows

On Windows, TextEditor+ uses the same files as the OpenSSH client built into Windows, in the `.ssh` folder of your user folder (`C:\Users\<you>\.ssh`):

- your key files (`id_ed25519`, `id_ecdsa`, `id_rsa`, or those named in `.ssh\config`);
- `.ssh\config` for host names, ports, user names and key files;
- `.ssh\known_hosts` for the servers you trust.

The Windows OpenSSH agent (the ssh-agent service) isn't used: TextEditor+ reads keys from the `.ssh` folder, and asks for a key's passphrase when it needs one. If you have no key yet, you can create one in a Command Prompt with `ssh-keygen -t ed25519`, or log in with a password.

The portable version never writes passwords or passphrases to its `settings` folder, so a copy of the folder on a USB stick carries no secrets. Your `.ssh` folder stays on the computer, not on the stick.

14 Printing

Choose **File > Print…** or press `⌘P` / `Ctrl+P`. Your system's print dialog opens. To print only part of the file, select that text first; the print dialog then offers to print just the selection.

The printout always uses the Light theme's colours, with syntax highlighting, in the editor's current font, so a dark theme never puts white text on a black background on paper.

15 Closing and quitting

15.1 Close Tab, Close Window and Quit

File > Close Tab (⌘W / Ctrl+W) Closes the current tab.

File > Close Window (⇧⌘W / Ctrl+⇧W) Closes the window and all its tabs.

Quit (⌘Q **, or** Ctrl+Q **on Linux**) Quits TextEditor+. On macOS, Quit is in the **TextEditor+** menu; on Windows and Linux, it's in the **File** menu.

Each of these first asks about unsaved changes (section 11.3).

15.2 On macOS

Like most Mac apps, TextEditor+ keeps running in the Dock after you close its window. It remembers the tabs and folder you had open (section 10.5) for the next time it starts, and the window comes back empty. To bring it back, do any of these:

- click the TextEditor+ icon in the Dock;
- drop a file or folder on the Dock icon, which opens it;
- choose **File > New Tab** or **File > Open…** from the menu bar.

To stop TextEditor+ completely, choose **TextEditor+ > Quit TextEditor+**, press ⌘Q, or Control-click the Dock icon and choose **Quit**.

15.3 On Windows and Linux

TextEditor+ has one window, so closing it also quits the program.

16 Keyboard shortcut reference

Command	macOS	Windows / Linux
File		
New Tab	⌘N or ⌘T	Ctrl+N or Ctrl+T
Open	⌘O	Ctrl+O
Open Folder	⇧⌘O	Ctrl+⇧O
Connect to Server	⌘K	Ctrl+K
Save	⌘S	Ctrl+S
Save As	⇧⌘S	Ctrl+⇧S
Print	⌘P	Ctrl+P
Close Tab	⌘W	Ctrl+W
Close Window	⇧⌘W	Ctrl+⇧W
Quit	⌘Q	Ctrl+Q (Linux)
Edit		
Undo / Redo	⌘Z / ⇧⌘Z	Ctrl+Z / Ctrl+Y
Cut / Copy / Paste	⌘X / ⌘C / ⌘V	Ctrl+X / Ctrl+C / Ctrl+V
Select All	⌘A	Ctrl+A
Find	⌘F	Ctrl+F
Replace	⌥⌘F	Ctrl+H (Ctrl+R on KDE)
Find Next	⌘G	F3
Find Previous	⇧⌘G	⇧F3
Go to Line	⌘L	Ctrl+L
Settings	⌘,	Ctrl+,
View		
Word Wrap	⌥Z	Alt+Z
Zoom In	⌘=	Ctrl+=
Zoom Out	⌘−	Ctrl+−
Actual Size	⌘0	Ctrl+0
Show Sidebar	⌘\	Ctrl+\
Show Preview	⇧⌘P	Ctrl+⇧P
Show as Grid (CSV/TSV)	⇧⌘G	Ctrl+⇧G
Next / Previous Tab	⌃Tab / ⌃⇧Tab	Ctrl+Tab / Ctrl+⇧Tab
Find bar		
Next match	Return	Enter
Previous match	⇧Return	⇧Enter
Close the find bar	Esc	Esc

17 Troubleshooting

Windows says “Windows protected your PC”

The Windows version isn’t signed. Click More info, then Run anyway, as described in section 2.2.

macOS says it can’t verify TextEditor+ or that it is damaged

This build is not notarised by Apple. Control-click the app and choose **Open**, or use Open Anyway in **System Settings > Privacy & Security**, as described in section 2.1.

A file shows strange characters such as “Ã©”

The file is probably in an encoding other than UTF-8 or Latin-1, such as Windows-1252 or UTF-16. TextEditor+ supports only UTF-8 and Latin-1.

TextEditor+ asks whether to open a file “anyway”

The file is either larger than 50 MB or looks like a binary file. Choose Open if you’re sure, or Cancel. See section 4.

The text runs off the right edge

Word wrap is off. Press `⌥Z` / `Alt+Z` or click Wrap.

The highlighting colours look wrong

Check the language box in the toolbar: a file with an unusual extension may need its language chosen by hand.

On a Mac, I closed the window and TextEditor+ is still in the Dock

That’s normal Mac behaviour. Click the Dock icon to get a new window, or press `⌘Q` to quit.

“The host key for … has changed”

See section 13. Don’t remove the old key unless you know why it changed.

I can’t log in to a server

Check that `ssh` or `sftp` works from a terminal with the same user name. TextEditor+ uses the same keys, `ssh-agent` (not on Windows) and `~/.ssh/config`. On Windows, if your key is only loaded in the Windows ssh-agent service, make sure the key file is also in your `.ssh` folder (section 13.5). For security, it refuses servers that only offer outdated encryption (such as CBC ciphers or SHA-1); such servers need updating.

Saving to a server fails with “permission denied”

TextEditor+ saves by creating a temporary file in the same folder, so it needs permission to create files there, not just to change the file.

Resetting all settings

Quit TextEditor+, then delete its settings:

- **macOS:** run `defaults delete com.sjwrc.TextEditor+` in Terminal.
- **Windows (portable version):** empty the `settings` folder in the TextEditor+ folder. If you removed it, delete this registry key instead:
  `HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\sjwrc\TextEditor+`
- **Linux:** delete `~/.config/sjwrc/TextEditor+.conf`.

The next time it starts, TextEditor+ uses its default window size, font, theme and word-wrap setting. This also forgets the saved servers and the Open Recent list.

18 About TextEditor+

TextEditor+ 3.0.0 was developed by Sanjeeva Wijeyesakere. To see the version you are running, choose **TextEditor+ > About TextEditor+** on macOS or **Help > About TextEditor+** on Windows and Linux.

TextEditor+ is free software, released under the GNU Affero General Public License, version 3 or later. It is built with the Qt framework, used under the GNU LGPL v3, and uses libssh (GNU LGPL 2.1) and OpenSSL (Apache 2.0) for SFTP. Bug reports and contributions are welcome on GitHub at github.com/swijeyes.